

2025 – 2026 Student Leader Agreement

University of St. Thomas Department of Residence Life

Title: Resident Advisor

Reports to: Community/Hall Director

Eligibility

1. I must maintain good academic standing throughout my term as Resident Advisor:
 - a. I must maintain a minimum cumulative grade point average of 2.5. If my cumulative grade point average drops below 2.5, I may be dismissed from this position.
 - b. If I receive a GPA below 2.5 in any semester, even if my cumulative GPA remains above a 2.5, I will receive a formal warning. I may be dismissed or have my position not renewed if my semester grades remain below a 2.5 GPA for two consecutive semesters.
 - c. I must maintain a full academic load (12 or more credits) during both the Fall and Spring semesters. Credits taken during J-Term do not count toward the 12-credit minimum requirement. Exceptions may be granted by the Associate Director of Residence Life.
2. I understand that I may be given a warning or dismissed should I be found responsible for violating the Student Code of Conduct and/or violate University of St. Thomas policies, state, or federal regulations.
3. I understand that evaluation of my performance is ongoing. If I am not meeting expectations, I may be given an opportunity to improve. I understand that I may be given a warning or dismissed should I fail to meet all stated expectations of the Department of Residence Life.

Time Commitment/Required Dates

1. I understand that the Resident Advisor position is considered a principal out-of-class activity. Any other formal commitments of my time **must be discussed with my Community/Hall Director prior to my engagement in such activities. These activities will be limited to a total of no more than 10 hours a week.** If at any time these outside commitments, even if totaling less than 10 hours a week, become a challenge to fulfilling my Resident Advisor responsibilities, especially with availability and visibility on the floor and in the hall, such commitments will need to be reevaluated in consultation with my Community/Hall Director and may need to be decreased or discontinued.
 - a. Conflicts with the RA position could include but are not limited to leadership or heavily involved participation in clubs and organizations, on- or off-campus employment, internships, varsity sports, or club sports.
 - b. I understand that the RA position is continuous from August 13, 2025, to May 31, 2026, including J-Term and all break periods.
2. I understand that I cannot hold this position if I participate in a semester long study abroad program or if I am planning to complete student teaching, or a similarly demanding practicum or internship, in either the fall or spring semesters.
3. Due to evening time commitments with the position, I understand I need to discuss taking any evening classes or any class that extends beyond 4:30 pm with my Community/Hall Director before registering for them. I may be told that I cannot take a particular evening class or that I may be allowed to only take one.
4. Anticipated dates of service for Academic Year 2025 – 2026 are as follows: August 13, 2025 – May 31, 2026.
5. I will attend all move-in and education and development dates indicated on the Position Overview.
6. I may take up to 6 nights (including weekends) away each semester (Fall and Spring). I understand that my time spent away from the campus must be approved by my Community/Hall Director prior to leaving campus.

7. Though J-Term may provide more flexibility for academic courses and study abroad, I must request and receive approval from my Community/Hall Director to take time away during J-Term, including but not limited to study abroad, VIA/VISION trips, and family trips.
8. I will be available for residence hall openings and remain for all hall closings and safety checks. Since halls will be open during J-Term and all breaks, including Thanksgiving, Christmas, Spring and Easter breaks, I understand that I will stay to complete room safety checks and/or “close” the building, may be responsible for duty coverage during all or part of those time periods, and am expected to continue to meet the responsibilities of the position. I will not make any travel arrangements for J-Term, breaks, or at the end of the academic year prior to discussing them with my Community/Hall Director due to my obligations in the hall. Duty coverage over all breaks is 12 hours that extends from 8:00 pm – 8:00 am.
9. The hours I spend on Resident Advisor responsibilities and activities will vary from week to week and may average 20 – 30 hours a week (not including sleeping and other inactive “on-duty” time). I agree to inform my Community/Hall Director if my activities and responsibilities as a Resident Advisor require 30 hours or more per week for two consecutive weeks.
10. The University understands that, from time to time, RAs may need to alter their schedule or miss a duty shift due to illness of the student or any of the conditions that constitute “Sick and Safe Time” under the University’s Sick and Safe Time Leave Policy. In such cases, the RA should contact their Community/Hall Director as soon as possible. For purposes of clarity, using sick and safe time does not reduce an RA’s stipend.

General Policies and Guidelines

1. I understand that I must become familiar with University policies and the Resident Student Handbook. I agree to be a positive role model while abiding by, explaining, and enforcing these policies. I understand that a violation of any policy may be grounds for disciplinary action including possible dismissal from my position.
2. It is my responsibility to be familiar with the Residence Life Student Leader Manual and the policies and procedures within each section. I will refer to my manual as needed to successfully fulfill my responsibilities.
3. I will obtain and maintain my University of St. Thomas email account and Outlook calendar system. I will check my University of St. Thomas email multiple times throughout the day.
4. I recognize that the University of St. Thomas requires a background check on all individuals with access to residence hall rooms and/or keys.
5. It is my responsibility to maintain a positive example for others in my personal, academic, and social behaviors on/off campus and via electronic/social media.

Alcohol Expectations

All references made to alcohol consumption refer to students of legal drinking age unless otherwise noted.

1. I understand that alcohol is disruptive to the community and abuse of alcohol is not conducive to the mission of the University. I will abide by all alcohol policies and expectations set forth by the University of St. Thomas and the Department of Residence Life. Failure to abide by the policies and expectations will result in disciplinary action, including probation or dismissal from this position.
2. If I am under the legal drinking age, I understand I am prohibited from consuming alcohol on or off campus. If found in a situation where there is alcohol present, I will remove myself from the situation.
3. If I am of legal drinking age, I understand that if I choose to use alcohol, I will use it responsibly and role model appropriate use and behavior.
4. I understand that I must remain alcohol and/or drug free when on duty, working the hall desk, performing Resident Advisor related duties, and responding to hall or campus incidents.

Discounts/Stipend

1. I have a housing agreement with the Department of Residence Life for the full term of the Resident Advisor position. During my term as a Resident Advisor, I will receive a discount for the full cost of my on-campus housing and meal plan so that I can live and dine in community with my residents and meet my responsibilities as a Resident Advisor. If I resign my position or am dismissed, the housing discount will be reversed on a pro rata basis, and I will have to pay for the remainder of my housing agreement should I choose to remain in on-campus housing. The meal plan will be removed from my account. These terms apply August 13, 2025 – May 31, 2026.
2. I will receive a stipend of \$450 for the academic year. Bi-Weekly payments will be made, and State and Federal taxes will be deducted from these payments if appropriate. If my RA role is interrupted due to University or Department operational changes, my stipend may be reduced.
3. I understand that the stipend and room and board I receive for this position may affect my financial aid award for 2025 – 2026 and that it is my responsibility to consult with my financial aid counselor to determine how my award may be affected.
4. If I am on duty during time periods when all food service options are closed, I will be provided eXpress funds. During some periods, the dining halls may be closed; I understand that I may need to use my provided meal plan's Dining Dollars when on duty over these time periods.
5. In late August, in between terms, after graduation, or any other time meal plans are not active on campus, I will be provided meals on campus or eXpress funds. These meals / eXpress funds are intended to support my work with residents. I understand I may need to supplement this with additional food / meals at my own expense.
6. I understand that if I am an international student, I may be subject to additional or different tax implications for discounts/stipends received in my role as a Resident Advisor.

This agreement is for the 2025 – 2026 academic year. I understand that my RA position may be terminated at any time and for any reason, including but not limited to changed operations of the University. Our intention, however, is to provide this leadership and learning opportunity for the duration of the academic year and to provide on-going performance assessment with opportunities to improve if necessary. Students performing at a high level may be eligible to return as a Resident Advisor based on reapplication and evaluation. The maximum period of service in this leadership position is generally two years.

If this agreement is terminated, I will only be entitled to receive the benefits that have been provided to me through the termination date.